

*Photographs by* **BANDEEP SINGH**

**and Deputy Editor ANILESH MAHAJAN on the BJP's strategy for the general elections. He talked confidently and candidly on a range of electoral issues without dodging tough questions. Excerpts:**

**Q. With the 2024 general election less than a year away, what are the BJP's plans to win a majority of seats on its own as it did in 2014 and 2019?**

Now if you look at 2014, the issue was corruption, policy paralysis, non-governance and the economy being in the doldrums. From 2014 to 2019, Prime Minister Modi worked on all fronts for the empowerment of all sections of the people, particularly the poor and the backward. Strong, bold decisions were taken on the economic front, on infrastructure, national security, strengthening defence and outreach in international relationships. By 2019, we were able to bring things back on track and set the momentum for even bigger changes.

**Q. Then at the start of the Modi government's second term, the pandemic struck...**

Yes. Although in these past four years, the world faced the worst pandemic of